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L26_Stocha...SS_Ergodic

 PDF



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Code snippet



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\documentclass[11pt]{article}
\usepackage[utf8]{inputenc}
\usepackage[margin=1in]{geometry}
\usepackage{amsmath, amssymb, amsfonts}
\usepackage{enumitem}
\usepackage{graphicx}
\usepackage{hyperref}

\title{\textbf{Lecture 26: Stochastic Processes Part 1} \ \ \large Stochastic Processes}
\author{Professional Scribe}
\date{April 14, 2026}

\begin{document}

\maketitle

\section{Introduction to Stochastic Processes}
A \textbf{stochastic process}  $X(\zeta, t)$  is defined as an entire collection of random variables indexed by time  $t$  and sample space  $\zeta$ .

\subsection{Key Concepts}
\begin{itemize}
\item \textbf{Realization:} A specific measured waveform from an ensemble of processes.
\item \textbf{Random Variable (R.V.):} If the process is "frozen" in time, it becomes a random variable.
\item \textbf{Multiple Variables:} By evaluating the process at different times, we obtain multiple random variables.
\end{itemize}

\section{Process Characterization}
Stochastic processes are characterized by their Probability Density Function (PDF) and statistical moments.

\begin{itemize}
\item \textbf{1st Order:} Describes the R.V. at a single time  $t$ .
\item \textbf{2nd Order:} Describes the joint probability across two different times.
\item \textbf{$n^{\text{th}}$ Order:} Provides a complete statistical characterization of the process.
\end{itemize}

\section{Statistical Moments}

\subsection{Mean Function}
The mean is the expected value of the random variable at a given time  $t$ .

\begin{equation}
\mu_X(t) = E[X(t)] = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x \cdot f_X(x, t) \, dx
\end{equation}
Generally, the mean changes as a function of time[cite: 172].

\subsection{Autocorrelation Function}
Measures the relationship between the process sampled at two different times.

\begin{equation}
R_{XX}(t_1, t_2) = E[X(t_1)X^*(t_2)]
\end{equation}

\textbf{Properties:}
\begin{itemize}
\item  $R_{XX}(t, t) = \mu_X(t)^2$  (Mean Square Value)
\end{itemize}

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$$R_{XX}(t_1, t_2) = R_{XX}^*(t_2, t_1)$$

$$\sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{j=1}^n a_i a_j^* R_{XX}(t_i, t_j) \geq 0$$

Autocovariance Function

Measures the relationship between the deviations of the process from its mean at two different times.

$$C_{XX}(t_1, t_2) = E[(X(t_1) - \mu_X(t_1))(X(t_2) - \mu_X(t_2))^*]$$

It is related to autocorrelation by: $C_{XX}(t_1, t_2) = R_{XX}(t_1, t_2) - \mu_X(t_1)\mu_X^*(t_2)$

Stationary Stochastic Processes

Strict Sense Stationary (SSS)

A process is SSS if its entire joint distribution is invariant under time shifts.

$$f_X(x_1, \dots, x_n; t_1, \dots, t_n) = f_X(x_1, \dots, x_n; t_1 + \tau, \dots, t_n + \tau)$$

For an SSS process, the mean μ_X is constant and the autocorrelation depends only on the time difference τ .

Wide Sense Stationary (WSS)

WSS is a weaker condition often used in practice [cite: 483]. A process is WSS if:

- Constant Mean: $E[X(t)] = \mu_X = \text{constant}$
- Lag-Dependent Autocorrelation: $E[X(t_1)X(t_2)^*] = R_{XX}(\tau)$ where $\tau = t_2 - t_1$

Note: SSS implies WSS, but WSS does not necessarily imply SSS.

Ergodic Process

A process is **ergodic** if its time averages are equal to its ensemble averages.

- Time Average (Mean): $\langle X(t) \rangle = \lim_{T \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{T} \int_0^T X(t) dt$
- Time-Average Autocorrelation: $R_{XX}(\tau) = \lim_{T \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{T} \int_0^T (X(t) - \mu_X)(X(t + \tau) - \mu_X)^* dt$

In an ergodic process, a single realization can represent the entire ensemble.

Summary of Mathematical Tools

Function	Formula
Mean Function	$\mu_X(t) = E[X(t)]$ [cite: 635]
Autocorrelation	$R_{XX}(t_1, t_2) = E[X(t_1)X(t_2)^*]$ [cite: 646]
Autocovariance	$C_{XX}(t_1, t_2) = R_{XX}(t_1, t_2) - \mu_X(t_1)\mu_X^*(t_2)$ [cite: 647]
Cross-Correlation	$R_{XY}(t_1, t_2) = E[X(t_1)Y(t_2)^*]$ [cite: 666]

